

POWER PACKED GE F404 engines for the Tejas on the HAL Bengaluru assembly line

"We are confident of making the engine meet the highly stringent and demanding requirements of Indian defence customers"

–C B ANANTHAKRISHNAN, *HAL Chairman & MD*

sibility of the F414 engines made in India through the HAL-GE Aerospace collaboration being exported.

WHAT INDIA NEEDS TO MASTER

Jet engine manufacturing is a complex task. With 80 per cent transfer of technology for the F414 engine, Indian manufacturing content in LCA Tejas Mk 2 would go up to 76 per cent from the existing 56 per cent. GE has offered around 11 key technologies to HAL. Indian aeronautical engineers/ technicians at HAL will have to master these cutting edge processes in a given time frame for the project to be on track. It will take an estimated three years to deliver the first engine. Moreover, it is up to Indian jet engine designers/ engineers to absorb as much as they can from this opportunity to develop a fully indigenous Indian jet engine in the future. ■

THE CHANGE-MAKERS

HINDUSTAN AERONAUTICS LIMITED

HAL chief C.B. Ananthakrishnan played a key role in making the deal a reality. H. Lawrence Culp Jr., chairman and CEO of GE Aerospace also highlighted economic and national security benefits for both US and India

SAFRAN: Other than GE, French firm Safran also plans to collaborate in the manufacture of a powerful 110kN engine to power India's ambitious sixth generation Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA) Mk–II fighter jet

UEC-KLIMOV: Russia's St. Petersburg–based UEC–Klimov enterprise of the United Engine Corporation has been in India since 2007, making the RD–33MK jet engine and so far has produced nearly 150 engines for MiG 29 fighter jets